BLACK MEDIA INTELLIGENCE PIPELINE · RESEARCH BRIEF

Editorial Topic Analysis: Black Media Coverage of Social Conflict

A systematic analysis of social justice and social conflict topic coverage across seven major Black media publications over a rolling 30-day window, using TF-IDF keyword scoring and seed-phrase topic matching.

REPORT DATE
November 01, 2026

ANALYSIS WINDOW
October 02, 2026 – November 01, 2026

TOTAL ARTICLES
1349

PUBLICATIONS
9

TOPICS TRACKED
12

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Key findings from this analysis period.

TOTAL ARTICLES
1349
Across 9 publications

ARTICLES TAGGED
128
Matched ≥1 topic

COVERAGE RATE
9.5%

Of total corpus

MOST COVERED TOPIC

Economic Equity & We…

35 articles

Key Finding — During this period, 9.5% of articles addressed at least one tracked social conflict topic. The three most-covered topics were: Economic Equity & Wealth Gap (35), Voter Suppression (31), Policing & Public Safety (26).

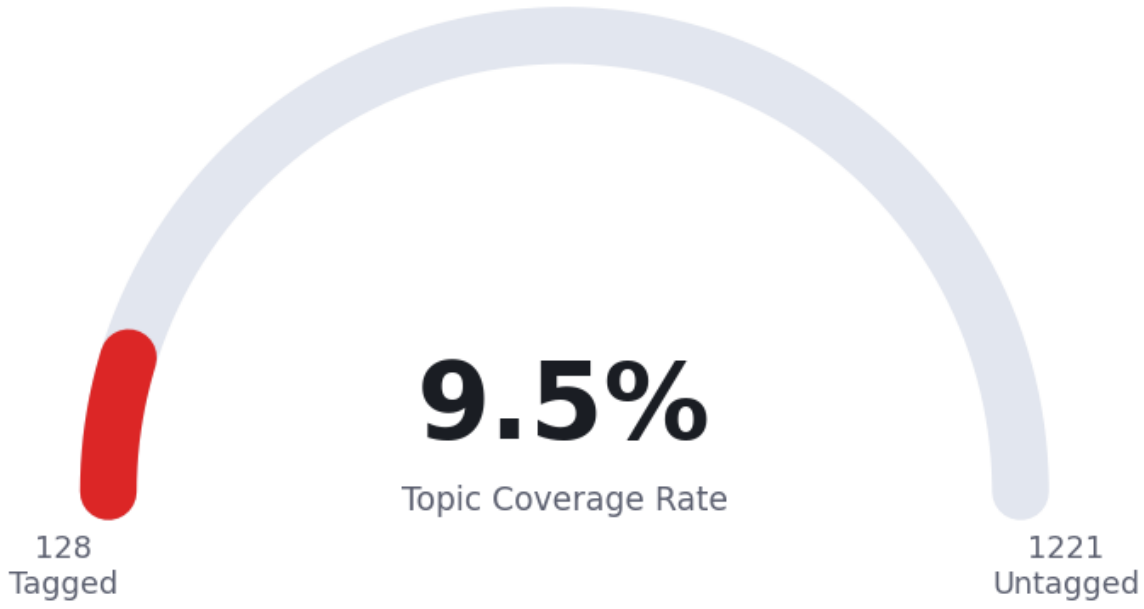


Figure 1.1 — Topic coverage rate for this reporting period

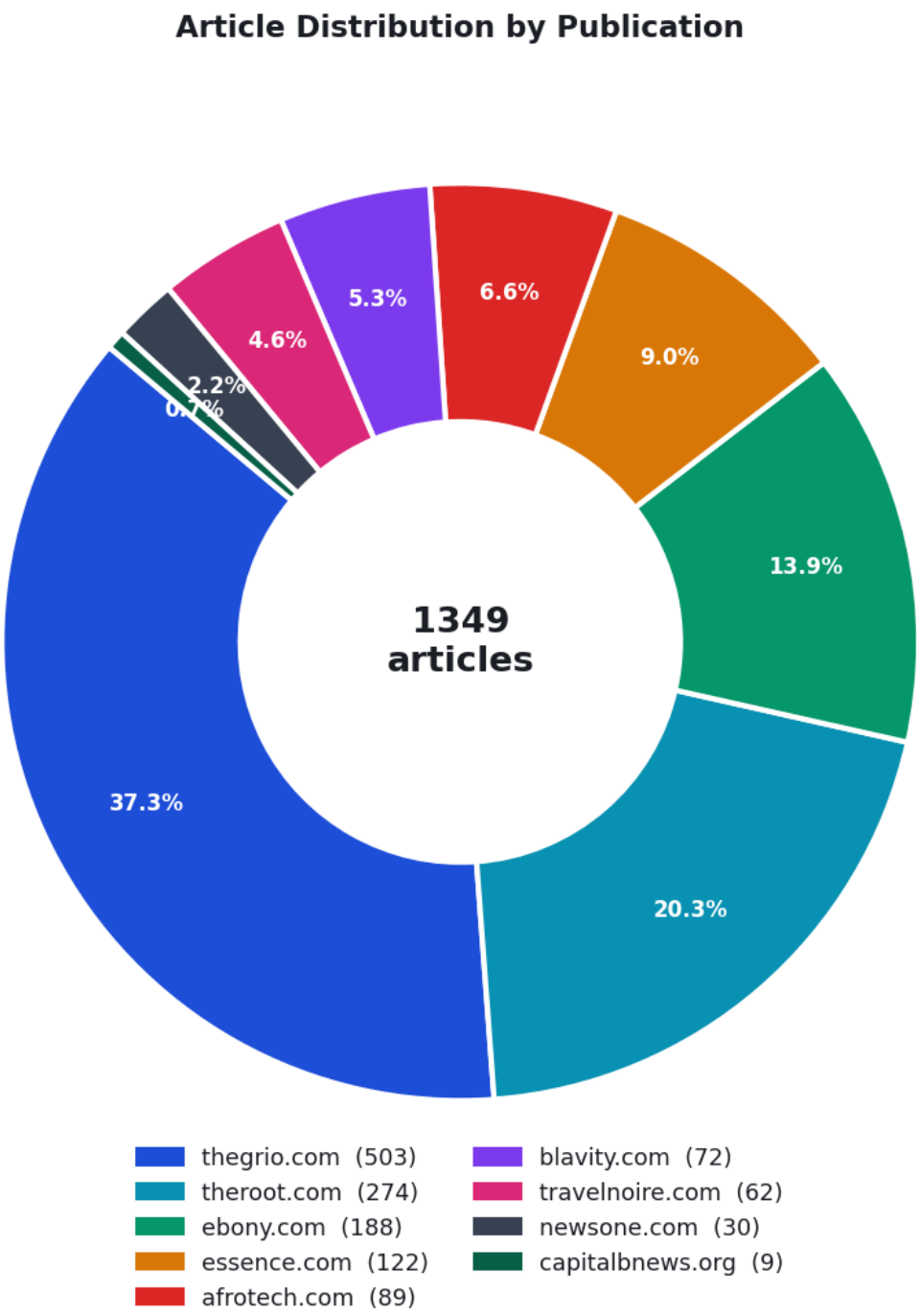


Figure 1.2 — Article distribution by publication

SECTION 02

Publication Overview

Per-publication article counts, topic coverage rates, and dominant topics for this reporting period.

PUBLICATION	ARTICLES	TOPICS COVERED	TAGGED	COVERAGE RATE	DOMINANT TOPIC
thegrio.com	503	8	47	9.3%	**Voter Suppression**
theroot.com	274	8	33	12.0%	**Voter Suppression**
ebony.com	188	6	10	5.3%	**Economic Equity & Wealth Gap**
essence.com	122	5	13	10.7%	**Economic Equity & Wealth Gap**
afrotech.com	89	2	4	4.5%	**Economic Equity & Wealth Gap**
blavity.com	72	5	10	13.9%	**Voter Suppression**
travelnoire.com	62	2	6	9.7%	**Economic Equity & Wealth Gap**
newsone.com	30	1	4	13.3%	**Policing & Public Safety**
capitalbnews.org	9	1	1	11.1%	**Book Bans & Anti-DEI**

SECTION 03

Topic Frequency Analysis

Frequency of each social conflict topic across all publications during this period, ranked by article count.

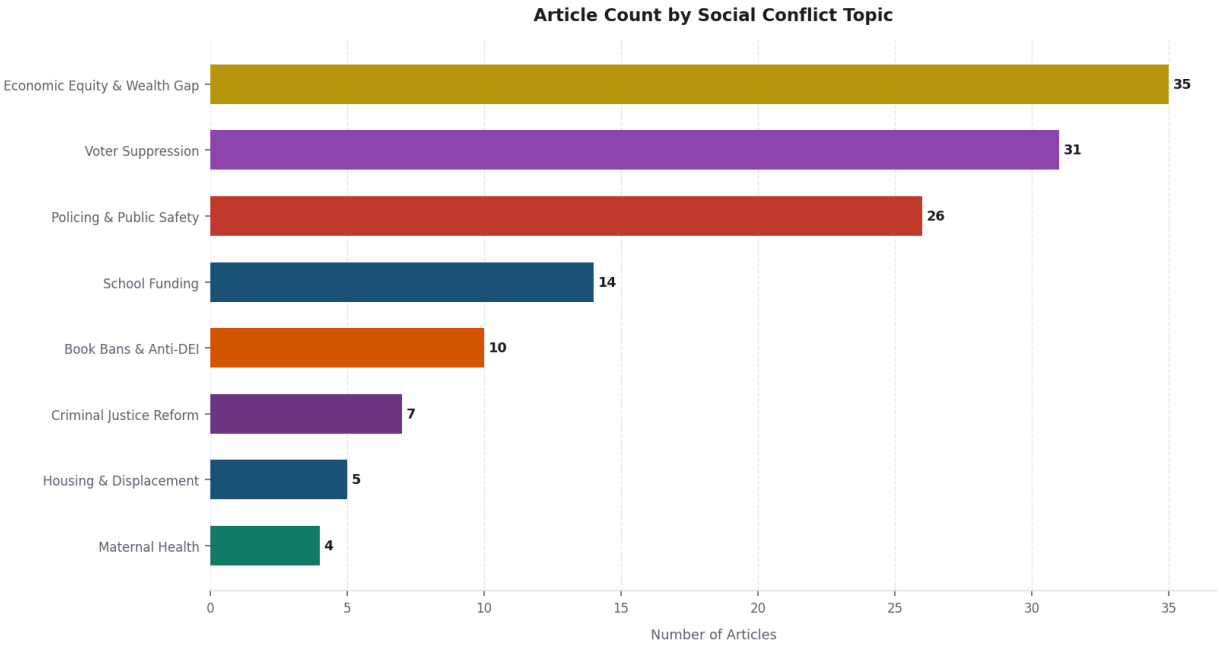


Figure 3.1 — Article count by social conflict topic (all publications)

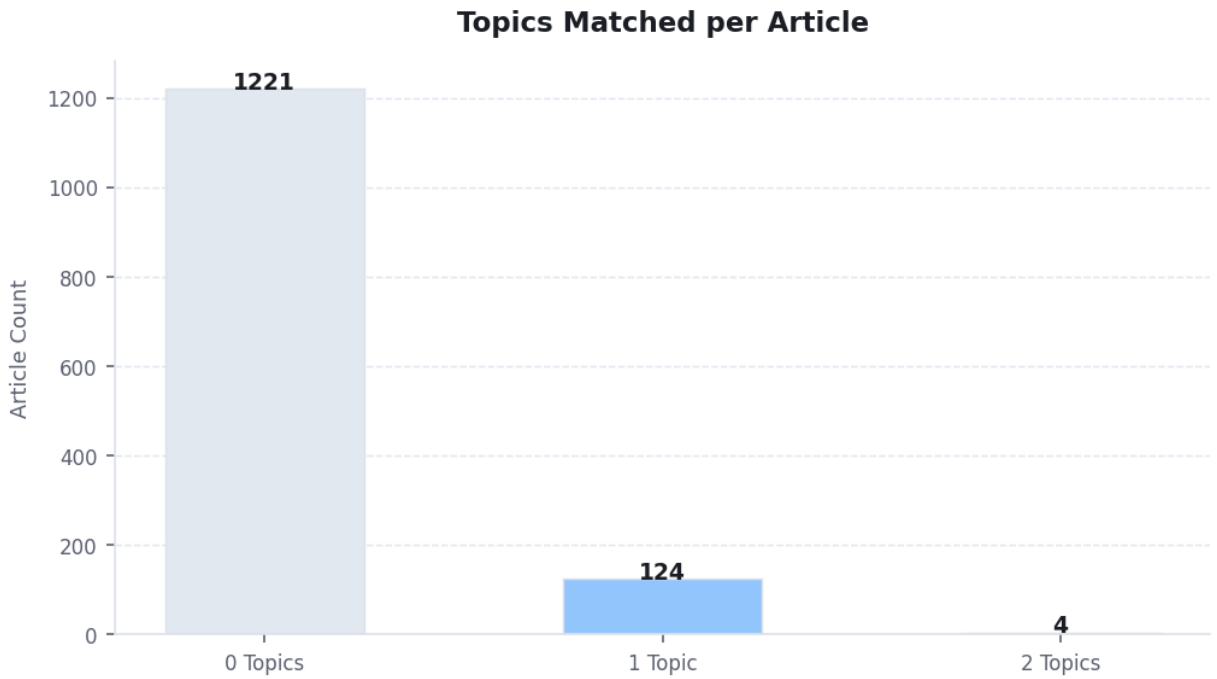


Figure 3.2 — Number of distinct topics matched per article

SECTION 04

Publication × Topic Coverage Matrix

Cross-tabulation of topic coverage by publication. Cell values represent the number of articles in which each topic was detected.



Figure 4.1 — Topic coverage heatmap (publications × topics)

SECTION 05

Publication Timeline

Daily article volume across all publications over the 30-day analysis window, with per-publication breakdowns.

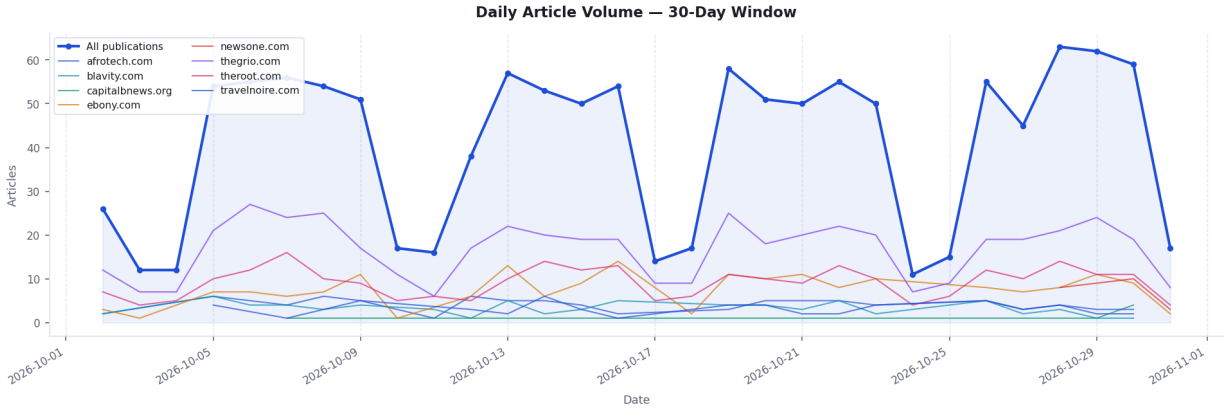


Figure 5.1 — Daily article volume by publication (October 02, 2026 – November 01, 2026)

SECTION 06

TF-IDF Keyword Analysis

Terms and phrases with the highest TF-IDF scores across the full article corpus, representing language that is distinctively prominent in this reporting period.

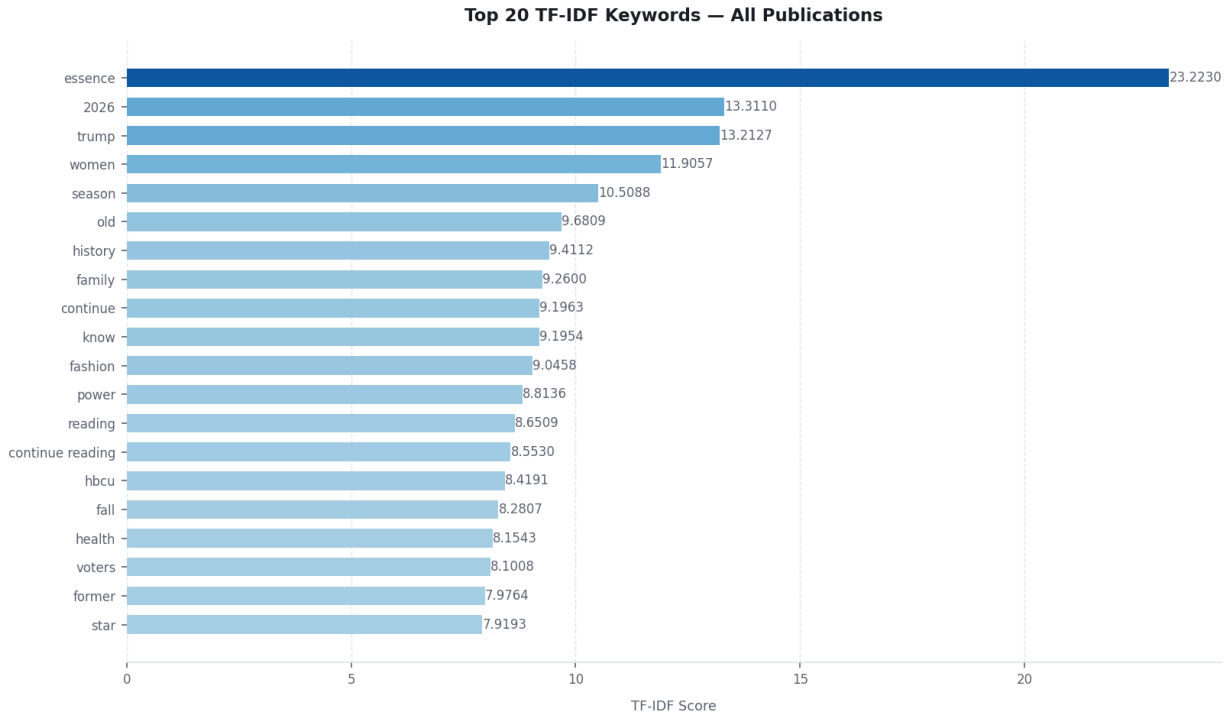


Figure 6.1 — Top 20 TF-IDF keywords (n-grams 1–3, all publications)

essence	23.2230
2026	13.3110
trump	13.2127
women	11.9057
season	10.5088
old	9.6809
history	9.4112
family	9.2600
continue	9.1963
know	9.1954
fashion	9.0458
power	8.8136
reading	8.6509
continue reading	8.5530
hbcu	8.4191
fall	8.2807
health	8.1543
voters	8.1008
former	7.9764
star	7.9193
home	7.8916
show	7.5806
love	7.5522
life	7.5220
look	7.4229
york	7.3629
university	7.3093
best	7.2867

us	7.2861
ahead	7.1776

SECTION 07

Topic Deep Dive & Article Index

For each detected social conflict topic: all matched articles with title, publication, date, category, URL, and the specific phrases that triggered the match.

Economic Equity & Wealth Gap

35 articles

Racial wealth gap, Black entrepreneurship, wage discrimination, economic mobility, poverty

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Paint The Polls Black: Voting Rights And 2026 Midterm Election Guide https://www.essence.com/news/paint-the-polls-black-2026-election-town-hall-recap/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	News	black economic
Black Wealth Has Dropped 25% And Experts Warn Policy Changes Could Make It Worse - Essence https://www.essence.com/news/black-wealth-has-dropped/	ESSENCE.COM	Bridgette Bartlett Royall	nan	News	black wealth black net worth
Zeta Day On The Hill Transforms Advocacy To Action - Essence https://www.essence.com/news/politics/zeta-day-on-the-hill/	ESSENCE.COM	Bridgette Bartlett Royall	nan	Politics	economic justice

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Star Gazing: Inside ESSENCE's 2026 Black Women In Business Celebration - Essence https://www.essence.com/entertainment/star-gazing-black-women-in-business-2026/	ESSENCE.COM	Okla Jones	nan	Entertainment	black business
Tamron Hall Wore A Black Woman-Designed Power Suit To Be Honored At ESSENCE's Black Women In Business Luncheon https://www.essence.com/fashion/tamron-hall-letwa-billey-bwib/	ESSENCE.COM	Elizabeth Ayoola	nan	Fashion	black business
Inside The 2026 ESSENCE Black Women In Business VIP Gift Bags - Essence https://www.essence.com/beauty/essence-black-women-in-business-gift-bags-2026/	ESSENCE.COM	Akili King	nan	Beauty	black business
'Less Is More' Black-Owned Beauty Products To Try - Essence https://www.essence.com/video/less-is-more-black-owned-beauty-products-to-try-2025/	ESSENCE.COM	https://www.facebook.com/essence	nan	Video	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
The Lip Bar Says It Aims To Reach More Customers At Target Beyond Its Millennial Black Women Base https://afrotech.com/the-lip-bars-aims-to-reach-more-customers-beyond-its-millennial-black-women	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-10-30	Business	black business
The Lip Bar Is Expanding Its Audience, Not Abandoning Black Women https://www.ebony.com/the-lip-bar-is-expanding-its-audience-not-abandoning-black-women/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-29	Beauty	black-owned
The Diaspora's Island Luxe Index: Black-Owned And Black-Influenced Stays Across The Caribbean https://travelnoire.com/black-owned-luxury-caribbean-resorts	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Mitti Hicks	2026-10-29	Black Owned	black-owned
Michigan Secretary of State Jocelyn Benson Says She'll Bring Higher-Paying Jobs to Black Voters in Episode 5 of 'What's Popular?' https://www.theroot.com/michigan-secretary-of-state-jocelyn-benson-says-shell-b-2000133135	THEROOT.COM	Shanelle Genai	2026-10-29	Politics	black wealth

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
How America's First Black-Owned Film Production Company Is Ushering in a New Era of Cinema https://www.theroot.com/how-america-s-first-black-owned-film-production-company-2000129714	THEROOT.COM	Asheea Smith	2026-10-28	Black Business	black business, black-owned
The Lip Bar controversy puts a spotlight on how Black-owned brands are faring amid the Target boycott https://thegrio.com/2026/10/28/the-lip-bar-controversy-puts-a-spotlight-on-how-black-owned-brands-are-faring-amid-the-target-boycott/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-10-28	Lifestyle	black-owned
'We grow better together, baby!': Cardi B wants Grow-Good to grow with Black-owned beauty supply stores https://thegrio.com/2026/10/28/cardi-b-grow-good-black-owned-beauty-supply-stores/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-10-28	Featured	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
The 2026 Stakes: Where Candidates Stand on Black Wealth, Voting, and Power https://www.theroot.com/the-2026-stakes-where-candidates-stand-on-black-wealth-2000132452	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-26	Culture	black wealth
Headed to AFROTECH™? Here Are 7 Houston Favorites to Order With Uber Eats for Less https://travelnoire.com/afrotech-houston-uber-eats	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Joshua Rodgers	2026-10-26	Branded Content	black-owned
Financial Expert On The Reason Black Wealth is On The Decline https://www.theroot.com/financial-expert-on-the-reason-black-wealth-is-on-the-d-2000131675	THEROOT.COM	William Ketchum	2026-10-23	News	black wealth wealth gap
Black unemployment is nearing twice the white rate. Economists say America should pay attention https://thegrio.com/2026/10/23/black-unemployment-is-nearing-twice-the-white-rate-economists-say-america-should-pay-attention/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-23	Politics	black unemployment

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Indianapolis' Daptoberfest To Bring Online Black-Owned Businesses IRL https://travelnoire.com/daptoberfest-indianapolis-black-owned	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-10-23	Black Owned	black-owned
Exclusive: Angie Nixon Responds to Abolishing Policing Criticism https://www.theroot.com/exclusive-angie-nixon-responds-to-abolishing-policing-2000131763	THEROOT.COM	Ty Cole	2026-10-22	America. In Black.	racial wealth gap, wealth gap
Black Household Wealth Fell 25% While White, Hispanic And Asian Households Gained. Here's What Drove It, Per New Fed Data https://blavity.com/black-household-wealth-fell-25-percent-fed-data	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-10-20	News	black wealth
Trump mistakenly celebrates 'highest' Black poverty rate while touting his economy https://thegrio.com/2026/10/20/trump-black-poverty-rate/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-20	Politics	black poverty

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
EXCLUSIVE: National Urban League backs NYC delivery workers, pushes back against legislation threatening Black businesses https://thegrio.com/2026/10/19/exclusive-national-urban-league-backs-nyc-delivery-workers-pushes-back-against-legislation-threatening-black-businesses/	THEGRIO.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-10-19	Featured	black-owned
EXCLUSIVE FIRST LOOK: Episode 2 of 'America Amended' Explores Free Expression in Detroit https://www.theroot.com/exclusive-first-look-episode-2-of-america-amended-expl-2000131170	THEROOT.COM	Ty Cole	2026-10-18	Black Business	black business
What To Know About The Guest House, A Black-Owned Antebellum-Era Mansion Turned Hotel In Mississippi https://travelnoire.com/black-owned-hotel-1840-antebellum-mansion-natchez	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-10-14	Black Owned	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Menswear Brand Tayion Collection Announces Major North American Expansion https://www.ebony.com/menswear-brand-tayion-collection-announces-major-north-american-expansion/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-14	Fashion	black-owned
11 Black-owned brands to fall for this autumn https://thegrio.com/2026/10/14/11-black-owned-brands-to-fall-for-this-autumn/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-10-14	Lifestyle	black-owned
As Black wealth drops 25%, critics say Trump's agenda is making the squeeze worse https://thegrio.com/2026/10/14/black-wealth-drops-25-trumps-agenda-is-making-the-squeeze-worse/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-14	Politics	black wealth, economic inequality
Check out These Black-Owned Restaurants in the Nation's Capital https://www.theroot.com/check-out-these-black-owned-restaurants-in-the-nations-2000129998	THEROOT.COM	Mahalia Otshudy	2026-10-11	Black Love	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
NYC Is Doubling Its Artist Grants To $10K For The First Time In Nearly 20 Years Under Mamdani: Here's Where And When To Apply https://blavity.com/nyc-artist-grants-mamdani-increase-how-to-apply	BLAVITY.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-10-11	News	economic justice
Earn Your Leisure co-founders Rashad Bilal and Troy Millings on why financial empowerment matters for Black communities https://thegrio.com/2026/10/10/earn-your-leisure-rashad-bilal-troy-millings-thegrio-interview/	THEGRIO.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-10-10	Featured	economic empowerment financial literacy
Fifty Leven Wine Founder Kindra Dionne On Virginia Wine Country, Black Entrepreneurship, And What's Next https://travelnoire.com/fifty-leven-wine-kindra-dionne-virginia	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-10-08	Black Owned	black-owned
The HBCU Network Is the Cheat Code Nobody Talks About https://www.ebony.com/the-hbcu-network-is-the-cheat-code-nobody-talks-about/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-06	Education	economic mobility

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
BeyGOOD Foundation Provides $50K Grant To Nonprofit Organization Championing The Next Generation Of Leaders https://afrotech.com/beygood-foundation-provides-50k-grant-to-in-a-perfect-world	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-10-05	Education	economic equity
Black unemployment rises sharply to 7% as economists point to Trump policies https://thegrio.com/2026/10/02/black-unemployment-rises-sharply-to-7-as-economists-point-to-trump-policies/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-02	Politics	black unemployment

Voter Suppression

31 articles

Voting rights, ballot access restrictions, gerrymandering, election interference, disenfranchisement

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Paint The Polls Black: Voting Rights And 2026 Midterm Election Guide https://www.essence.com/news/paint-the-polls-black-2026-election-town-hall-recap/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	News	voting rights
Mail-In Voting Is Safe For The Midterms. LaTosha Brown Says The Fight Is Far From Over https://www.essence.com/news/politics/mail-in-voting/	ESSENCE.COM	Victoria Uwumarogie	nan	Politics	ballot access

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
- Essence https://www.essence.com/authors/rayna-reid-rayford/	ESSENCE.COM	—	nan	Authors	ballot access
Paint the Polls Black 2026: Town Hall Dates and How to Watch https://www.essence.com/news/politics/paint-the-polls-black-2026-town-halls/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	Politics	early voting voter registration
Eric Holder urges Black voters to fight gerrymandering: 'My vote doesn't count' is 'nonsense' https://thegrio.com/2026/10/30/eric-holder-urges-black-voters-to-fight-gerrymandering-my-vote-doesnt-count-is-nonsense/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-30	Politics	gerrymandering
Former U.S. Attorney General Eric Holder says Keisha Lance Bottoms could be key to stopping racial gerrymandering in Georgia https://thegrio.com/2026/10/30/former-u-s-attorney-general-eric-holder-says-keisha-lance-bottoms-could-be-key-to-stopping-racial-gerrymandering-in-georgia/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-30	Politics	gerrymandering
What Black Texans Want Ahead of The Midterms https://www.theroot.com/what-black-texans-want-ahead-of-the-midterms-2000132747	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-29	Culture	voting rights

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
These Black Celebs Push Voter Engagement Ahead of the Midterms https://www.theroot.com/these-black-celebs-push-voter-engagement-ahead-of-the-m-2000132851	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-28	Entertainment	black voter
When We All Vote and NC A&T Double Down On Voting Efforts https://www.ebony.com/when-we-all-vote-and-nc-at-double-down-on-voting-efforts/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-28	Culture	early voting
When We All Vote's Nearly 700 Early Voting Gatherings See Marsai Martin, Trinity Tatum And More Bring Folks To The Polls https://blavity.com/when-we-all-vote-700-early-voting-gatherings	BLAVITY.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-10-28	Politics	early voting
Texas Senate Hopeful James Talarico Pledges Federal Support for Black Businesses and Voting Rights in Episode 4 of 'What's Popular?' https://www.theroot.com/texas-senate-hopeful-james-talarico-pledges-federal-sup-2000132619	THEROOT.COM	Shanelle Genai	2026-10-27	Politics	voting rights
The 2026 Stakes: Where Candidates Stand on Black Wealth, Voting, and Power https://www.theroot.com/the-2026-stakes-where-candidates-stand-on-black-wealth-2000132452	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-26	Culture	voting rights

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Barack Obama backs Maryland ballot measure that could reshape congressional map https://thegrio.com/2026/10/26/barack-obama-maryland-redistricting-ballot-measure/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-26	Politics	redistricting
Voting machine complaints spread online, but officials say there's no evidence of widespread vote switching https://thegrio.com/2026/10/23/touchscreen-voting-machine-problems-2026-midterms/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-23	Politics	voting machine
Coalition including NAACP and National Urban League rally Black men to vote as organizations confront midterm turnout gap https://thegrio.com/2026/10/21/national-black-man-voter-day-initiative/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-21	News	black voter
'Beyond disrespectful': Black conservative TikTok creator says she was booted from GOP event in Texas https://thegrio.com/2026/10/19/thelma-louise-black-conservative-content-creator-gop-event/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-19	News	early voting
North Carolina College Students Turn Protest Into Action at the Polls https://www.ebony.com/north-carolina-college-students-turn-protest-into-action-at-the-polls/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-19	News &Amp; Politics	early voting

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
State-by-State Early Midterm Election Predictions https://www.ebony.com/state-by-state-early-midterm-election-predictions/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-19	News &Amp; Politics	early voting
North Carolina A&T, UNC Greensboro and Bennett College students march to polling location after campus polling locations were removed https://thegrio.com/2026/10/16/north-carolina-at-unc-greensboro-march-polling-locations/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-16	News	early voting
NAACP Announces Massive Nationwide Campaign to Mobilize Black Male Voters https://www.theroot.com/naacp-announces-massive-nationwide-campaign-to-mobilize-2000131062	THEROOT.COM	Rashad Grove	2026-10-16	News	black voter
Voter Intimidation Is A Concern This Midterm. When We All Vote Is Planning Parties At The Polls In Response https://blavity.com/when-we-all-vote-poll-parties-midterms	BLAVITY.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-10-14	Politics	voter intimidation
Kamala Harris says ‘you’re not going to take my joy’ or our voting rights ahead of midterms https://thegrio.com/2026/10/13/kamala-harris-not-take-my-joy-keke-palmer-interview/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-10-13	Featured	voting rights

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Georgia governor's race candidates Keisha Lance Bottoms and Rick Jackson urge voters to cast early ballots https://thegrio.com/2026/10/13/georgia-governors-race-early-voting-bottoms-jackson/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-13	Politics	early voting
WATCH: 'America Amended' Ep. 1: Black Americans Died for the Right to Vote. Has It Given Us Real Power? https://www.theroot.com/watch-america-amended-ep-1-black-americans-died-for-2000130167	THEROOT.COM	Ty Cole	2026-10-11	America. In Black.	voting rights
Judge strikes down Justice Department policy to use voter rolls for citizenship checks https://thegrio.com/2026/10/10/doj-voter-roll-policy-judge-ruling/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-10	Politics	voter rolls
Tayari Jones' Kin wins 2026 Kirkus Prize for fiction, earns $50,000 https://thegrio.com/2026/10/09/tayari-jones-kin-kirkus-prize/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-09	News	jim crow
HRC president says attacks on civil rights give Black and LGBTQ voters shared stakes in 2026 https://thegrio.com/2026/10/06/hrc-president-attacks-on-civil-rights-black-lgbtq-voters-2026/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-06	Politics	black voter

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
If You Haven't Registered to Vote Yet, Oct. 5 Is Your Last Chance in These States https://www.theroot.com/if-you-haven-t-registered-to-vote-yet-oct-5-is-your-l-2000129270	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-05	Politics	redistricting
The Supreme Court's new term is underway. Here's what's at stake for Black Americans https://thegrio.com/2026/10/05/supreme-court-new-term-whats-at-stake-for-black-americans/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-05	Politics	voting rights
Black voters of Baton Rouge's Scotlandville community face new political reality after Louisiana redistricting https://thegrio.com/2026/10/05/louisiana-redistricting-scotlandville-black-voters/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-05	Politics	redistricting
From Racist Toys to Hate Artifacts: Inside the New $22M Jim Crow Museum https://www.theroot.com/from-racist-toys-to-hate-artifacts-inside-the-new-22m-2000129133	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-10-05	Culture	jim crow

Policing & Public Safety

26 articles

Police reform, use of force, accountability, community safety, officer-involved shootings, qualified immunity

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Charlotte Police Investigated For Racist Texts Targeting Black Residents - Essence https://www.essence.com/news/charlotte-police-investigated-for-racist-texts/	ESSENCE.COM	Bridgette Bartlett Royall	nan	News	police department
ICE Agent Who Struck Migrant With Vehicle Indicted By Texas Grand Jury https://newsone.com/6875196/mario-alberto-bam-morales-indicted/	NEWSONE.COM	Zack Linly	2026-10-30	Civil Rights & Social Justice	ice agent immigration enforcement
Hackers Leak Identifying Info Of 41,000 DHS Employees https://newsone.com/6875100/department-of-peace-hackers-leak-dhs-employees/	NEWSONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-10-29	Nation	immigration enforcement homeland security
EXCLUSIVE: Nevada Gov. Joe Lombardo admits he 'marginalized other communities' as law enforcement officer https://thegrio.com/2026/10/28/nevada-governor-lombardo-marginalizing-communities/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-10-28	Politics	law enforcement
Hulu's New Show 'Phony' Has Black People Hooked https://www.theroot.com/hulus-new-show-phony-has-black-people-hooked-2000132744	THEROOT.COM	Shanelle Genai	2026-10-28	Entertainment	chokehold
ICE Is Functioning As The New COINTELPRO, Report Finds https://newsone.com/6874988/ice-functioning-as-new-cointelpro/	NEWSONE.COM	Stephen A. Crockett Jr.	2026-10-28	Civil Rights & Social Justice	immigration enforcement

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
ICE Has Held Black US Citizen Who Suffers Mental Illness In Custody For A Year, Court Records Show https://newsone.com/6875008/phillip-james-mental-illness-ice-custody/	NEWSONE.COM	Zack Linly	2026-10-28	Civil Rights & Social Justice	immigration enforcement
FAMU students protest campus police cooperation with ICE https://thegrio.com/2026/10/24/famu-students-protest-ice-agreement/	THEGRIO.COM	Bobby Pen	2026-10-24	Politics	police department
Ohio father who ran over deputy one day after son was killed in a police shooting convicted of murder https://thegrio.com/2026/10/23/rodney-hinton-guilty-murder-trial/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-23	News	killed by police
Officer who fatally shot 1-year-old Kohen Wiley resigns from Mississippi police department https://thegrio.com/2026/10/23/mississippi-officer-resigns-kohen-wiley-fatal-shooting/	THEGRIO.COM	Bolarinwa Oladeji	2026-10-23	News	police department
Mississippi town faces new lawsuit days after DOJ settlement over police misconduct https://thegrio.com/2026/10/22/lexington-police-lawsuit-filming-officers/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-22	News	police misconduct

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
No Charges For Officer Who Shot 1-Year-Old Kohen Wiley: What To Know About The Ruling, The Video And The Family's Questions https://blavity.com/no-charges-for-officer-who-shot-1-year-old-kohen-wiley	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-10-22	News	police officer officer fired
Mississippi Clears Officer in Death of 1-Year-Old, but Questions Remain https://www.theroot.com/mississippi-clears-officer-in-death-of-1-year-old-but-2000131406	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-20	Criminal Justice	body camera
Mississippi Attorney General says officers were 'justified' in shooting death of 1-year-old Kohen Wiley https://thegrio.com/2026/10/19/kohen-wiley-shooting-mississippi-attorney-general/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-19	News	use of force
These Black Pro Athletes Joined Law Enforcement in Retirement https://www.theroot.com/these-black-pro-athletes-joined-law-enforcement-in-reti-2000131020	THEROOT.COM	Rashad Grove	2026-10-18	Sports	law enforcement
These Court Cases Put Black Lives and Accountability in the Spotlight https://www.theroot.com/these-court-cases-put-black-lives-and-accountability-in-2000131127	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-17	Crime	police accountability

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
NBA Hall of Famer Amar’e Stoudemire graduates from Miami law enforcement academy https://thegrio.com/2026/10/16/amare-stoudemire-police-academy-graduation/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-16	Entertainment	law enforcement police department
Charlotte-Mecklenburg Police Racist Texts: A Timeline Of What We Know So Far https://blavity.com/charlotte-mecklenburg-police-racist-texts-a-timeline-of-what-we-know-so-far	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-10-16	News	police department
DOJ settles with Mississippi Police Department found to have often violated civil rights of Black residents https://thegrio.com/2026/10/16/doj-settlement-lexington-missisippi-police-department-civil-rights-violations/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-16	News	police department
The Raid on Rep. Ilhan Omar’s Home Isn’t About Law Enforcement – It’s About Intimidation https://www.theroot.com/the-raid-on-rep-ilhan-omars-home-isnt-about-law-enforc-2000130339	THEROOT.COM	Randi Bryant	2026-10-13	Opinion	law enforcement

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Investigation Uncovers a Secret Charlotte-Mecklenburg Police Department Group Chat That Was Allegedly Full of Racist Texts https://www.theroot.com/investigation-uncovers-a-secret-charlotte-mecklenburg-p-2000130277	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-10-13	Crime	police department
Congresswoman Ilhan Omar's Home Was Raided Following Years-long Feud With Trump Administration https://www.ebony.com/congresswoman-ilhan-omars-home-was-raided-following-years-long-feud-with-trump-administration/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-13	News &Amp; Politics	law enforcement homeland security
Body-Cam Footage of Fatal Police Shooting of Unarmed Black Teen Raises Urgent Questions https://www.theroot.com/body-cam-footage-of-fatal-police-shooting-of-unarmed-bl-2000129884	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-09	Criminal Justice	unarmed black
Dr. Anita Allen makes history as Mableton's first Black woman police chief https://thegrio.com/2026/10/09/dr-anita-allen-mableton-police-chief/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-10-09	Featured	police department

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Opinion: The Memphis Safe Task Force is the Wrong Model for America https://www.theroot.com/opinion-the-memphis-safe-task-force-is-the-wrong-model-2000129886	THEROOT.COM	Dr. William E. Arnold, Jr., Ph.D.	2026-10-09	Opinion	public safety
Supreme Court rejects Betty Shelby appeal, allowing Terence Crutcher civil rights case to proceed https://thegrio.com/2026/10/07/betty-shelby-appeal-terence-crutcher/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-07	News	excessive force

School Funding

14 articles

Education funding disparities, underfunded schools, school closures, Black student outcomes

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Ahead of Historic Midterms, HBCUs Are Building a Civic Infrastructure to Last - Essence https://www.essence.com/news/ahead-of-historic-midterms-hbcus-are-building-a-civic-infrastructure-to-last/	ESSENCE.COM	Skylar Mitchell	nan	Culture	education equity
Student Loan Forgiveness Scores a Major Legal Victory. Here's What Borrowers Need to Know https://www.ebony.com/student-loan-forgiveness-scores-a-major-legal-victory-heres-what-borrowers-need-to-know/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-22	Education	student loan

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Nikole Hannah-Jones Just Responded to the Outrage Over Her Viral NYT Essay https://www.theroot.com/nikole-hannah-jones-just-responded-to-the-outrage-over-2000131616	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-10-21	Culture	school choice
Southern University Students Struggle To Keep Up With Coursework Due To Frequent Power Outages https://afrotech.com/southern-university-students-dealing-with-frequent-power-outages	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-10-20	Education	historically black college
As France's student protests make headlines, remember the legacy of Black student activism https://thegrio.com/2026/10/19/as-frances-student-protests-make-headlines-remember-the-legacy-of-black-student-activism/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-10-19	Lifestyle	black student
What you need to know if you have federal student loans right now https://thegrio.com/2026/10/15/what-you-need-to-know-if-you-have-federal-student-loans-right-now/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-10-15	Personal Finance	student loan

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Black Colorado Student Sues Charter School, Alleging Administrators Failed To Stop Racial Harassment From White Classmates https://blavity.com/black-colorado-student-sues-charter-school-failing-to-stop-racial-harassment	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-10-15	News	black student charter school
Grambling State University Awarded $350K To Advance Biomedical Research And STEM Pathways https://afrotech.com/grambling-state-university-awarded-350k-nih-grow-contract	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-10-14	Education	historically black college
Black family files civil rights complaint alleging 7 years of racial harassment in Illinois school district https://thegrio.com/2026/10/07/antioch-school-discrimination-complaint/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-07	News	school district
Black teen sues Colorado charter school after ‘slave auction’ graffiti named him, lawsuit says https://thegrio.com/2026/10/07/addenbrooke-racial-harassment-lawsuit/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-07	News	black student charter school
Why Trump’s HBCU Funding Boost Is Drawing Backlash From Black, Hispanic And Asian American Lawmakers https://blavity.com/trumps-hbcu-funding-boost-is-drawing-backlash	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-10-06	Politics	hbcu funding

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Black Student Aces Teacher's Chemistry Test After 25 Years https://www.theroot.com/black-student-aces-teachers-chemistry-test-after-25-yea-2000129090	THEROOT.COM	Asheea Smith	2026-10-05	Black Excellence	black student
After 'Cornell Seven,' Black LSU Student Shares a Similar Story on Social Media https://www.theroot.com/after-cornell-seven-black-lsu-student-shares-a-similar-2000128863	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-04	Criminal Justice	black student
California DOJ says school district discriminated against Black students in discipline policies https://thegrio.com/2026/10/03/natomas-school-discipline-black-students-settlement/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-03	News	school district

Book Bans & Anti-DEI

10 articles

Censorship of Black literature, DEI rollbacks, critical race theory bans, curriculum restrictions

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
‘A Lot Of Black People Are Wondering, What Are We Getting For Our Loyalty?’ ESSENCE Black Futures Now Honorees Speak Candidly About The Upcoming Election - Esse https://www.essence.com/video/black-history-month-black-futures-now-voter-panel-davis-ferrell-zabala/	ESSENCE.COM	https://www.facebook.com/essence	nan	Video	black history month
What Black Augusta Voters Want from Their School Board https://capitalbnews.org/augusta-voters-school-board-election-2026/	CAPITALBNEWS.ORG	Renetta DuBose	2026-10-30		school board
The DEI Watchlist Is the Latest Weapon in America’s War on Black Progress https://www.theroot.com/the-dei-watchlist-is-the-latest-weapon-in-americas-war-2000133218	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-30	Culture	dei

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Young advocates push for Broward County (Fla.) School Board to make menstrual products accessible to all students https://thegrio.com/2026/10/27/young-advocates-push-for-broward-county-fla-school-board-to-make-menstrual-products-accessible-to-all-students/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-10-27	Lifestyle	school board
Federal appeals court overturns Mississippi anti-DEI ruling, removes judge over AI errors https://thegrio.com/2026/10/24/mississippi-anti-dei-law-appeals-court-judge/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-10-24	News	dei, anti-dei
Don’t Let UK Black History Month 2026 Slip Away Without These London Events https://travelnoire.com/uk-black-history-month-what-to-do-london	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-10-23	Culture	black history month

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
It’s Black History Month in The UK: 13 Black British History Icons You Need to Know https://www.theroot.com/its-black-history-month-in-the-uk-13-black-british-his-2000131541	THEROOT.COM	Mahalia Otshudy	2026-10-21	Culture	black history month
A Memphis Native’s Self-Taught AI Course Led to Helping Job Seekers Navigate the Job Search With MatchMentum https://www.ebony.com/a-memphis-natives-self-taught-ai-course-led-to-helping-job-seekers-navigate-the-job-search-with-matchmentum/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-12	Current Culture News	dei, anti-dei
Why Those 300,000 Black Women Who Lost Jobs Are Suffering https://www.theroot.com/why-those-300-000-black-women-who-lost-jobs-are-sufferi-2000129739	THEROOT.COM	Mahalia Otshudy	2026-10-08	News	dei

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Trump administration probes Wells Fargo over efforts to boost Black homeownership https://thegrio.com/2026/10/07/trump-administration-wells-fargo-probe-black-homeownership/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-07	News	dei

Criminal Justice Reform

7 articles

Mass incarceration, sentencing disparities, prison conditions, bail reform, reentry programs

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
No U.S. Execution Has Ever Been Livestreamed. The Pentagon Says Nidal Hasan's Will Be, And The Backlash Is Global https://blavity.com/pentagon-livestream-plan-backlash-nidal-hasan	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-10-11	Politics	execution
'It's not entertainment': Black soldier who survived 2009 Fort Hood shooting slams idea of livestreaming shooter's execution https://thegrio.com/2026/10/10/alonso-lunsford-nidal-hasan-fort-hood-execution/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-10	News	execution

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Botched Lethal Injection Raises Urgent Medical Ethics Questions After Christa Pike Ends Up On Life Support https://blavity.com/christa-pike-survives-lethal-injection-hospitalized-ventilator	BLAVITY.COM	Dr. Diana Rangaves, PharmD	2026-10-09	Conditions &Amp; Care	death row
The U.S. wants to livestream Nidal Hasan's execution. Black Americans know the history of public killing https://thegrio.com/2026/10/09/the-u-s-wants-to-livestream-nidal-hasans-execution-black-americans-know-the-history-of-public-killing/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-10-09	News	execution
Texas Executes Black Man Amid Botched Christa Pike Lethal Injection https://www.theroot.com/texas-executes-black-man-amid-botched-christa-pike-leth-2000129749	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-08	Crime	execution
Pentagon confirms Fort Hood shooter's firing squad execution to be livestreamed https://thegrio.com/2026/10/08/pentagon-livestream-execution-fort-hood-shooter/	THEGRIO.COM	DeMicia Inman	2026-10-08	News	execution
Here's What Happened to Christa Pike's Accomplices https://www.theroot.com/heres-what-happened-to-christa-pikes-accomplices-2000128956	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-02	Crime	execution

Housing & Displacement

5 articles

Affordable housing, eviction crisis, gentrification, homelessness, housing discrimination

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Stevie Wonder Seeking Eviction of Ex-Fiancée https://www.theroot.com/stevie-wonder-seeking-eviction-of-ex-fianc-e-2000132338	THEROOT.COM	Rashad Grove	2026-10-25	News	eviction
An Agent's Alleged Racist Text Shatters a Couple's Dream Home https://www.theroot.com/an-agent-s-alleged-racist-text-shatters-a-couple-s-drea-2000132035	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-25	Culture	housing discrimination
Here's What To Know About Atlanta's Eviction Crisis https://www.ebony.com/heres-what-to-know-about-atlantas-eviction-crisis/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-10-13	Current Culture News	eviction
Austin Gentrifiers In Viral Video Sparks Outrage After Citing $1.5M Home Value to HBCU Students https://www.theroot.com/austin-gentrifiers-in-viral-video-sparks-outrage-after-2000129874	THEROOT.COM	Shanelle Genai	2026-10-09	Hbcus	gentrification
Trump administration probes Wells Fargo over efforts to boost Black homeownership https://thegrio.com/2026/10/07/trump-administration-wells-fargo-probe-black-homeownership/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-10-07	News	black homeownership

Maternal Health

4 articles

Black maternal mortality, obstetric racism, prenatal care disparities, childbirth outcomes

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
What Black Texans Want Ahead of The Midterms https://www.theroot.com/what-black-texans-want-ahead-of-the-midterms-2000132747	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-10-29	Culture	maternal health
Comedian Jasmin Brown opens up about suffering from postpartum depression https://thegrio.com/2026/10/15/comedian-jasmin-brown-opens-up-about-suffering-from-postpartum-depression/	THEGRIO.COM	Maxwell Millington	2026-10-15	Entertainment	postpartum postpartum depression
Medicaid cuts put maternity care at risk as hospitals close labor and delivery units https://thegrio.com/2026/10/11/medicaid-cuts-maternity-ward-closures/	THEGRIO.COM	Bobby Pen	2026-10-11	Health	pregnancy care
Tatyana Ali’s experience highlights an often-overlooked part of Black maternal health — the need to get up and bust a move https://thegrio.com/2026/10/08/tatyana-alis-experience-highlights-an-often-overlooked-part-of-black-maternal-health-the-need-to-get-up-and-bust-a-move/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-10-08	Health	maternal health black maternal postpartum

SECTION 08

Topic Word Clouds

Visual frequency maps of headline language in articles matched to each topic. Term size reflects relative frequency across matched article titles.

Key Terms: Policing & Public Safety



Policing & Public Safety

Key Terms: Voter Suppression



Voter Suppression

Key Terms: Book Bans & Anti-DEI



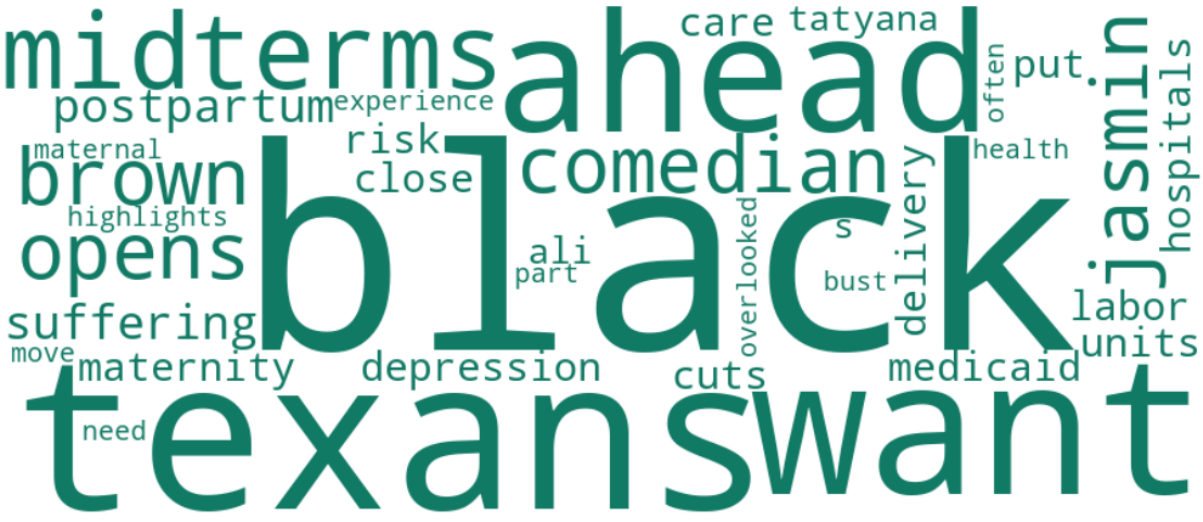
Book Bans & Anti-DEI

Key Terms: Housing & Displacement



Housing & Displacement

Key Terms: Maternal Health

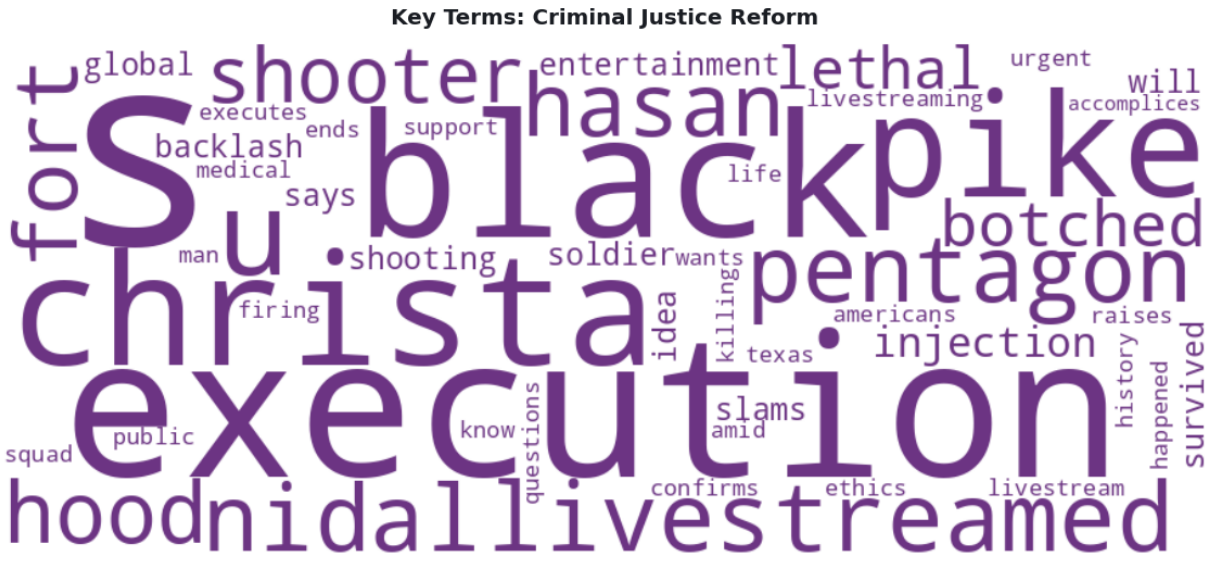


Maternal Health

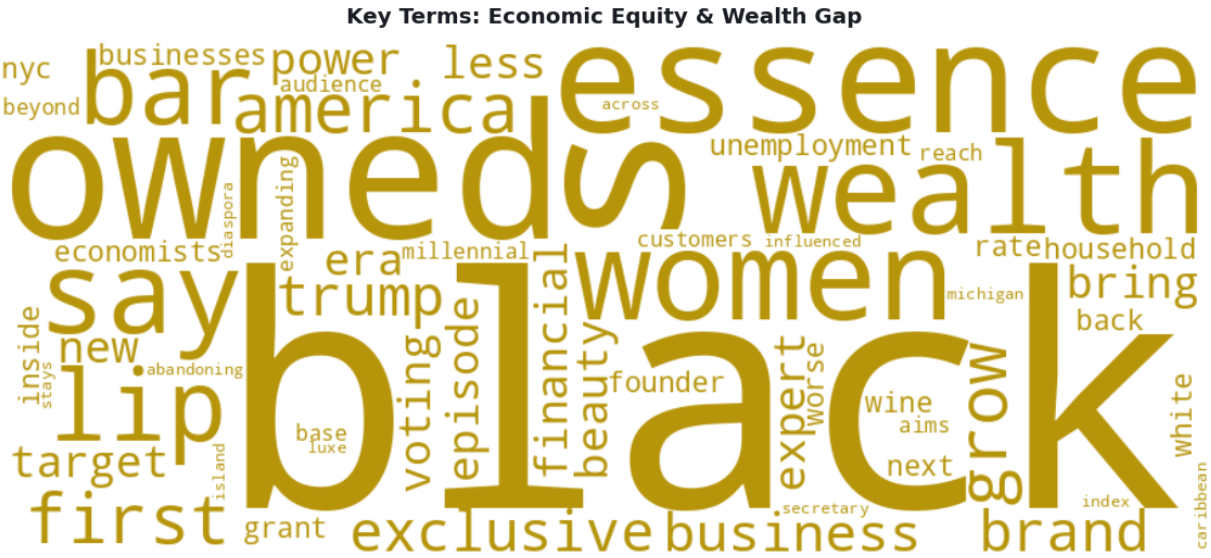
Key Terms: School Funding



School Funding



Criminal Justice Reform



Economic Equity & Wealth Gap

SECTION 09

Methodology

Data collection, analysis approach, and known limitations.

Data Collection. Articles were scraped from 7 Black media publications (The Grio, The Root, NewsOne, Capital B News, Blavity, Essence, Ebony) using RSS feeds as the primary method and HTML scraping as a fallback. Only articles with a publication date within the 30-day window ending **November 01, 2026** were included. Each article record captures: title, snippet/description, publication, date, category, and URL.

Topic Matching. Each article's title, description, and category were matched against a curated dictionary of 12 social conflict topics. Each topic contains 20–35 seed phrases. Matching uses whole-word regular expression search (case-insensitive) with optional suffix flexibility (plurals, verb forms). Articles can match multiple topics simultaneously.

TF-IDF Keyword Extraction. Term Frequency–Inverse Document Frequency (TF-IDF) scoring was applied to the full corpus using scikit-learn's `TfidfVectorizer` (n-grams 1–3, min_df=2, max_df=0.85, sublinear TF normalization). Scores represent a term's relative prominence in this period compared to its overall distribution across the corpus.

Limitations. (1) Topic matching is constrained by the seed phrase dictionary — articles using different terminology for the same issue may not be captured. (2) RSS feed snippets vary in length and completeness by publication; full article body text is not analyzed. (3) The 30-day rolling window does not capture longer-term trends. (4) Coverage rates reflect the share of articles that explicitly reference tracked topics, not the total editorial attention given to those topics.

Tracked Topics (12). Policing & Public Safety · Voter Suppression · Book Bans & Anti-DEI · Housing & Displacement · Maternal Health · Redlining & Fair Housing · Anti-Black Surveillance · Reparations · School Funding · Criminal Justice Reform · Environmental Justice · Economic Equity & Wealth Gap.